

JULY 2026

NEWSLETTER

Mill House Neighbourhood House

A place to learn • share • volunteer • connect

Everyone is welcome at
Mill House



Mill House is your local community hub — a place to learn, share, volunteer and connect.

We provide a welcoming, inclusive and empowering space that supports community connection, lifelong learning, social inclusion and local participation.

Mill House is run by a dedicated team

STAFF

Manager: Sarah Mclean

Admin Assistant: John Howden

Reception: Simone Dukker

VOLUNTEERS

Kay, Jen, Rachel, Pete, Trish, Jesse, Sam, Jessica, Will, Gavin, Lea, Martin, Josh, Di, Rodney, David, Sue-Ellen, Oj

COMMITTEE OF MANAGEMENT

President: John Williamson

Vice President: Reyne Canning

Treasurer: Patricia Rainbow

Secretary: Samantha Redrich

GENERAL COMMITTEE

Cathy Schwager

Dianne Parsons

Molly Masson

Shaun Talbot

Our activities & programs are supported by and funded through



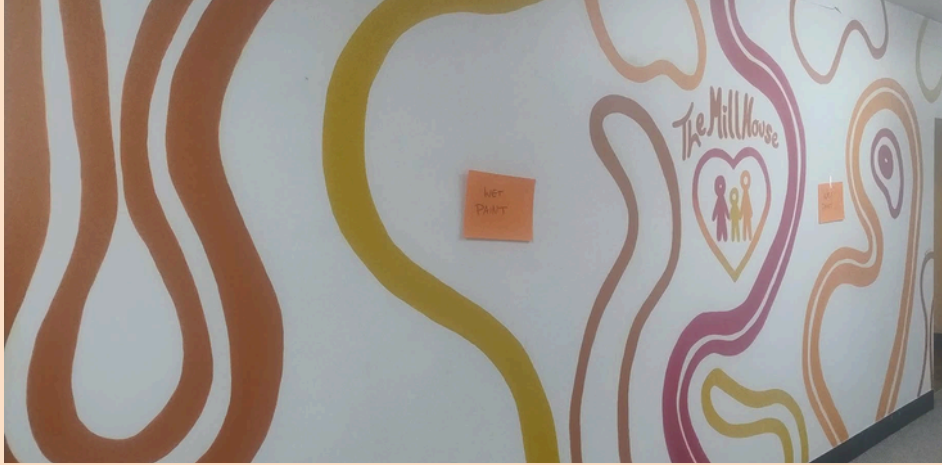
Families,
Fairness and
Housing



2026 SO FAR

A colourful welcome

Our hallway received a bright new mural during the first half of 2026. The flowing colours and special Mill House design have brought warmth, creativity and personality into the building.



The mural helps make our community space feel brighter, more welcoming and uniquely ours.



SilverChef kitchen upgrade

Funding through the SilverChef grant helped Mill House purchase new commercial cooking and food-service equipment. The equipment strengthens our ability to prepare community meals safely and efficiently.



Fresh new flooring

New flooring was installed through the reception, dining and main community areas by Maryborough Floor Coverings. It has given Mill House a cleaner, brighter and more modern look.



COMMUNITY HIGHLIGHTS

Sharing skills, celebrating together and making connections

Bright Sparks at Mill House

During April and May, Mill House partnered with Bright Sparks to share practical information about home electrification and energy-efficient cooking.



Community members saw induction cooktops and air fryers in action, asked questions and learned simple ways to reduce energy use. Bright Sparks also supported Friday Feast community lunches

First Maryborough Beanie Bonanza

In July, the Maryborough Yarn and Craft Group joined with Mill House to hold the first Maryborough Beanie Bonanza. The event showcased locally handmade beanies in creative styles for all ages, celebrated local talent and raised funds to support Mill House. Thank you to the crafters and everyone who supported this colourful community event.



**Top Beanie seller
Wayne from
Connecting
Futures**



Mother's Day Lunch

Mill House celebrated Mother's Day with a special community lunch filled with good food, laughter and friendship.



Several lucky guests took home beautiful hampers filled with donated gifts and treats. Thank you to everyone who attended, donated items, prepared food and helped make the day enjoyable.

CREATIVITY & CONNECTION

Local talent, welcoming groups and a new way to stay connected

Playgroup

Wednesdays, 10.30am-12.30pm
A relaxed, child-led space where young children and their caregivers can connect, explore and learn through play.

Canasta

Come along for a friendly and social game of Canasta. New and experienced players are welcome to join in.



Canasta is played Fridays, 1pm-4pm

Yarn Craft - The Hookers

Fridays, 1pm-3pm

A friendly group where people can learn, practise and share crochet, knitting and other yarn crafts. All skill levels are welcome.

New website coming soon

Our refreshed Mill House website is expected to be up and running within the next two weeks.

It will make it easier to find information about programs, services, weekly activities, room hire, volunteering, membership and community events.

Watch our Facebook page for the official launch

Art for the Soul

Resident artist Will Johns leads a relaxed and welcoming space where people of all skill levels can create, learn new techniques and enjoy conversation.



Art for the Soul runs on Wednesdays and Fridays.

Maker Mums

Mondays, 10am-1pm

A family-friendly sewing, crochet and craft group. Learn from others, share your skills and enjoy a relaxed, caring environment.



Dungeons & Dragons

A collaborative fantasy role-playing group where players create characters, explore imaginary worlds and shape stories together

Tuesdays

Beginners 9am - 12pm

.Experienced player 1pm - 4pm

Youth Activity Hub

Wednesdays, 3.30pm-5pm

A safe and welcoming after-school space where young people can enjoy gaming, board games, Dungeons & Dragons and other social activities.

FOOD @ MILL HOUSE

Affordable food, shared meals and practical support

Friday Feast

A freshly prepared community meal every Friday from 12pm to 1pm. Come along for good food and friendly conversation.

Food Share Market

Fresh food and pantry items are available on Thursdays from 9.30am to 11am. Bring your bags and take what you need for a small donation.

Food with Friends

A supported cooking group on Thursdays from 10am to 12pm where participants prepare food, build skills and share a meal.

24/7 Community Pantry

The pantry on the Mill House front veranda is available at any time for community members who need food support.

Frozen Meals

Affordable homemade frozen meals are available for purchase from reception.

Community Food Preparation

Volunteers help prepare meals, pack food, organise donations and support our regular food programs.

Mill House Cafe

Affordable social Cafe on Tuesdays from 11am - 1pm where you can get Barista coffee and homemade cake for \$5

Community Kitchen

Our community kitchenette is available to use. It includes free tea and coffee, a microwave, oven, fridge and dishwasher, providing a welcoming space to prepare food or enjoy a cuppa.

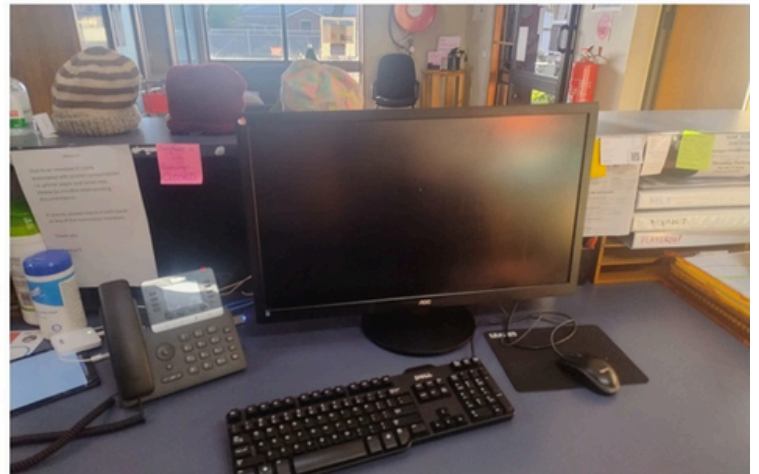
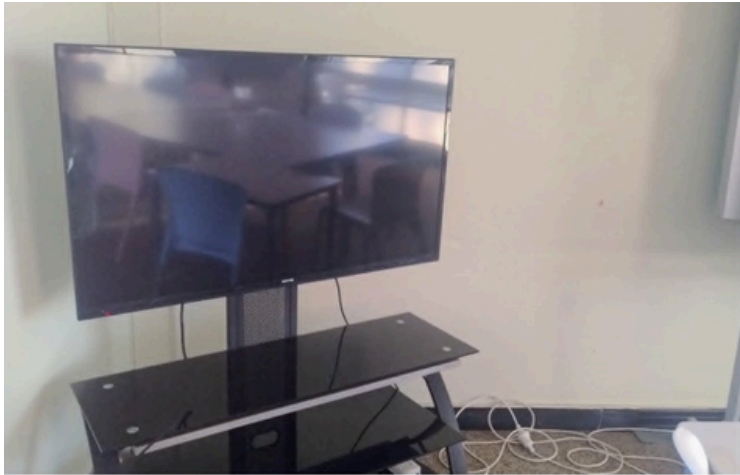
Food brings people together at Mill House

Our food programs provide affordable meals, practical cooking opportunities and food relief in a welcoming community setting.

DIGITAL INCLUSION & COMMUNITY CAPACITY HUB

Helping our community access technology, learning and support

Mill House's new Digital Inclusion and Community Capacity Hub is now up and running. During the first half of 2026, we upgraded our Wi-Fi network and introduced new computers, laptops and large screens throughout the building.



What the Hub supports

- Community access to computers and reliable Wi-Fi
- Digital learning and basic technology support
- Online appointments, workshops and local groups
- Youth gaming, creative media and storytelling activities

What's next

During the second half of 2026, the Hub will continue to grow through digital mentoring, one-to-one support and opportunities for young people to build skills in photography, video, podcasting and social media.

PROGRAMS & SERVICES

Practical support and community connections

No Interest Loans

Good Shepherd No Interest Loans for essential household items. Contact Mill House to make an appointment.

Parent Pathways

Flexible and personalised support for eligible parents and carers to work towards education and employment goals.

Justice of the Peace

Terry Simpson J.P. is available on Tuesdays from 10am to 2pm.

Spaces for Hire

Affordable boardrooms, lounges, kitchens, activity rooms, a computer room and offices for meetings and workshops.

Support & Referrals

Mill House can help connect community members with local services, information and referral pathways.

Cool Spaces

During heatwaves and extreme weather, Mill House provides a safe and welcoming place for the community to keep cool.

Regular Community Meetings

Maryborough Stamp Club

2nd Tuesday, 7pm–9pm – Board Room

Maryborough Theatre Company

2nd Tuesday, 7pm–9pm – Dining Room

U3A Book Club

2nd Tuesday, 1.30pm–3.30pm – Board Room

U3A Writers Group

1st Friday, 10am–12pm – Board Room

Friends of Maryborough Outdoor Pool

1st Tuesday, 7pm–9pm

Friends of Maryborough Town Hall

2nd Tuesday, 4.30pm–5.30pm

ALP

3rd Thursday, 6pm - 7pm

WHAT'S COMING UP

July to December 2026

24 JULY

Christmas in July

12pm

A warm and festive three-course community lunch featuring garlic prawns, roast meats and vegetables with all the trimmings, followed by trifle.

30 JULY

Winter Warmers Market

Come along and enjoy a winter market featuring local handmade goods, warm treats and community stalls.

18 AUGUST

Mill House AGM

4.30pm

Members and community supporters are invited to hear about our achievements, plans and opportunities for the year ahead.

31 OCTOBER

Halloween Spooktacular

Our popular family celebration returns with costumes, entertainment, activities, food and plenty of spooky fun.

17 DECEMBER

Christmas Market

Celebrate the festive season and support local makers, groups and small businesses at the Mill House Christmas Market.

18 DECEMBER

Community Christmas Lunch

Join us for our annual Christmas lunch with delicious food, festive fun, hamper prizes and plenty of Christmas cheer.

More information and bookings will be shared through reception, our Facebook page and the new Mill House website.

OUR CURRENT TENANTS

Organisations and services co-located at Mill House

AXIS Employment

**APM Employment
Services**

are-able

Connecting Futures

Machworks

FRRR

**Maryborough Remedial
& Sports Massage**

**Djerriwarrh Community
& Education Services**

ND Mind

GET INVOLVED

Everyone is welcome to be part of Mill House

Volunteer

Our volunteers are the heart of Mill House. Opportunities include reception, food programs, events, cleaning, youth activities and committee involvement.

Become a Member

Membership gives you a voice in the organisation and the opportunity to vote, share ideas or nominate for the Committee of Management.

Partner With Us

We welcome corporate sponsorships, community partnerships, room-based collaborations and auspice arrangements.

WEEKLY TIMETABLE

MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
Maker Mums 10am-1pm	Mill House Scrapbooking 10am-12pm	Playgroup 10.30am-12.30pm	Mill House Market 9.30am-11am	Friday Feast 12pm-1pm
	U3A Digital Storytelling 10am-1pm	Art for the Soul 9am-2pm	Food with Friends 10am-12pm	Art for the Soul 9am-2pm
	Mill House Cafe 11am-1pm	Peer Collective 2pm-4pm	Community Food Preparation 12.30pm -	Hookers Yarn Craft 1pm-3pm
	Terry Simpson J.P. 10am-2pm	Youth Activity Hub 3.30pm-5pm		Canasta 1pm-4pm
	Dungeons & Dragons 9am Beginners 1pm Players			

Mill House

Neighbourhood House

Thank You

Thank you to our staff, Committee of Management, volunteers, funders, partners, tenants, local businesses and community members.
Your time, support and generosity make Mill House possible.



Contact Mill House

Visit: 88–90 Burke Street, Maryborough VIC
3465

Call: 03 5461 3185

Email: manager@millhouse.org.au

Website: www.millhouse.org.au

Opening hours: Monday–Friday, 9am–4pm

Find us on Facebook

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